The Picture-Perfect Property

A practical guide to preparing your home for real estate photography.

A calmer room.
A clearer first impression.
A preparation plan you can actually follow.

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

Room-by-room preparation, the 48-hour plan, photography-day coordination and printable checklists.

Use this guide with your agent and photographer. It supports presentation, not a promise of sale price or selling speed. Follow their property-specific advice and local disclosure requirements.

The 48-hour plan

A focused sequence reduces last-minute moving and missed details.

48-24 hours / Clear and coordinate

Confirm appointment length, rooms, access and weather plans. Assign one person to each preparation zone. Declutter, identify the holding area, arrange pet care and complete deeper cleaning. Wash and dry textiles.

24-6 hours / Finish and stage

Arrange furniture, make beds and prepare towels. Clean mirrors and accessible windows. Test lights and gather keys or access instructions. Charge your phone and check any building entry restrictions.

Final 2 hours / Reset

Clear counters, empty bins and secure private documents. Park vehicles as agreed. Keep shoes and coats in the holding zone. Allow a buffer for children and pets. Stop making major layout changes once the photographer arrives.

Room-by-room checklist

Mark only the spaces included in your photography plan.

- ☐ Living: clear routes, smooth cushions, tidy shelves and hide cords.
- ☐ Kitchen: clear counters, empty sink, clean appliances and refrigerator door.
- ☐ Dining: straighten chairs and simplify the table.
- ☐ Bedrooms: smooth bedding, clear bedside tables and hide under-bed storage.
- ☐ Bathrooms: remove toiletries, clean glass, hang towels and close toilet lids.
- ☐ Office: secure documents, clear screens and contain cables.
- ☐ Entry: remove shoes, bags and parcels; sweep the threshold.
- ☐ Exterior: sweep paths, move bins and coordinate parking.
- ☐ Every room: check privacy, clean visible surfaces and test lights.